many of his ICS colleagues, was a graduate of Balliol College, Oxford. Joining the Indian Civil Service in 1885, he had had a long innings as the private secretary to the Governor of Madras prior to his posting in Tirunelveli. We can surmise that he had the complete trust of the governor. During his year as collector, Wynch presided over the suppression of the Swadeshi movement in the district and oversaw the destruction of SSNCo.

The Surat Congress and After

There was no discernible progress in achieving political rights in the country even after twenty years of annual Congress sessions. Bharati's remark that, '[t]hrough repeated pleading for rights our throats have only run dry', aptly expresses this frustration.[2] No wonder there were differences simmering within the organization. Having provided a critique of colonialism, and exposing the hollowness of British fair play, the Moderates, as the first generation of leaders were called—led by such figures as Pherozeshah Mehta and Gopalkrishna Gokhale—had outlived their historical role. Bal Gangadhar Tilak, Bipin Chandra Pal and the new crop of leaders, especially Aurobindo Ghosh—described as the Extremists—were impatient with the strictly constitutional methods that the Moderates advocated. Though the Congress, as its very name implied, was little more than an annual congregation with no organization to speak of, the differences soon came to a boil. A split in the Calcutta session (December 1906) was averted only by seating the universally respected grand old man Dadabhai Naoroji in the presidential chair. Though resolutions were passed on Swadeshi, boycott, national education and self-government, the year was spent debating on what they meant rather than implementing them. While the Moderates were adamant that boycott should not be extended beyond Bengal, the Extremists were eager to make it an all-India affair. The moderate leaders, greatly alarmed by the snowballing Swadeshi movement, tactically shifted the venue of the 1907 Congress session from Nagpur, a perceived Tilak stronghold, to Surat.